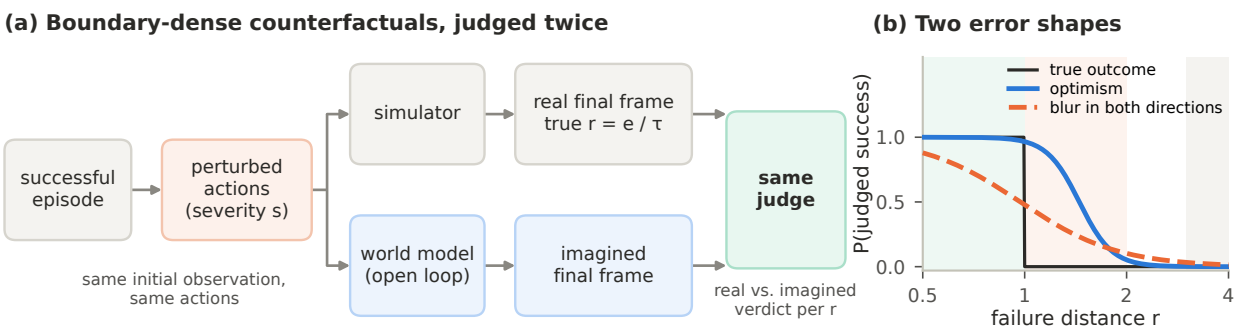
(a) Boundary-dense counterfactuals, judged twice
successful episode
perturbed actions (severity s)
same initial observation, same actions
simulator
real final frame true r = e / τ
world model (open loop)
imagined final frame
same judge
real vs. imagined verdict per r
(b) Two error shapes
true outcome
optimism
blur in both directions
P(judged success)
1.0
0.5
0.0
0.5
1
2
4
failure distance r